

3.4.2 What are the powers of local and devolved government and how can citizens participate?

- The role and structure of elected local government; the services provided by local government for citizens in local communities; roles and accountability of councillors.
- The nature and organisation of regional and devolved government: Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland and England.
- How powers are organised between the Westminster Parliament and the devolved administrations in Northern Ireland, Scotland and Wales; how relations are changing between England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland; the debate about 'English votes for English laws'.
- Who can stand for election and how candidates are selected.

- Who can and cannot vote in elections and why; debates about the voting age.
- Issues relating to voter turnout, voter apathy and suggestions for increasing voter turnout at elections.
- How public taxes are raised and spent by government locally and nationally.
- The practice of budgeting and managing risk and how it is used by government to manage complex decisions about the allocation of public funding.
- Different viewpoints and debates about how governments and other service providers make provision for welfare, health, the elderly and education.